FT FollowThrough

The Hauling & Transportation Playbook

What to say from the first call to the five-star review. Copy the lines, put them in your own words, and keep this on your phone.

1. The first call or message

Sound calm, understand the job, and book a next step. Ask:

- **For a move:** from where to where, what date, and how many rooms? Any stairs, elevators or long walks to the truck? A storage unit too?
- **For freight:** what is it, how much does it weigh, how big is it, and does it need straps or a tarp?
- What are the pickup and delivery hours, and who signs at each end?
- Is the date fixed, or can it move a day or two?

> "Thanks for calling [Business], this is [Name]. Tell me what needs moving and I'll see how we can help."

> "Could you do a quick video call and walk me through every room, closets and garage too? Then I can give you a price you can count on. Tonight at 6 or tomorrow at 12?"

2. Presenting the quote

- **Moves:** say whether the price is binding or an estimate, the crew size, the minimum, the hourly rate after it and travel time.
- **Freight:** put weight, size, dock hours, tarping and your detention and extra-stop fees on the rate confirmation.
- Send your insurance certificate and, for interstate work, your USDOT number.
- Say what the deposit holds, the refund policy, and when the rest is due.

> "Here's the crew, the time and the price, with everything spelled out. I can hold [date] for you with the deposit. What questions do you have?"

3. The 7 objections haulers and movers hear and what to say

Acknowledge it, ask a question, answer honestly, suggest a next step.

1. "Another company quoted me $400 less."
"That's worth a look. Is theirs a binding price or an estimate that can grow on moving day? Check the crew size, the rate after the minimum, travel time and what happens if something breaks. I'll send my quote with all of that spelled out so you can compare line by line."

2. "I'm still collecting quotes."
"Smart, especially for a move. Did the others see your place, or guess from the number of bedrooms? Quotes from a video walkthrough are closer to the real bill. End-of-month dates book up fast, so I can hold yours until Friday at no charge."

3. "I need to check with my manager."
"Of course. What will they want to see, the price, the insurance or how fast I can pick up? I'll send a one-page summary with my rates, my certificate of insurance and my USDOT number, and I'll call you Thursday morning."

4. “I’ll just rent a truck and get friends to help.”
“That works for a lot of people. How many friends can you count on for a full Saturday, and who’s carrying the sofa down three flights? We also do labor-only: you rent the truck and we load and unload it, which costs less than a full move. Want a quote for both?”

5. “I’ll book closer to the date.”
“Understood. When is your lease up? Weekends and the last few days of the month fill weeks ahead, and if your date goes, what’s left is a weekday or a rush price. I’ll pencil you in now and confirm the details the week before.”

6. “Why should we trust a one-truck outfit with our equipment?”
“Fair question. Has a hauler let you down before? Here’s my USDOT number so you can check my authority and safety record on FMCSA’s site, and a certificate of insurance made out to your company. I send photos at pickup and delivery, and you’ll have my cell number the whole way.”

7. “Why do you need a deposit just to book?”
“Fair question. Has a mover ever not shown up on you? The deposit holds your date and crew so I don’t give them to someone else. It comes off your final bill, the refund policy is on the estimate, and you pay the rest once everything’s in your new place and you’ve checked it over.”

4. Follow up: day 2, day 5, day 12

Most quotes go quiet, not “no”. Keep each message short and useful. Moves and loads book within days, so move fast.

> **Day 2:** “Hi [Name], it’s [Your name] from [Business]. Did the quote come through okay? Happy to answer any questions.”

> **Day 5:** “Hi [Name], I’m still holding [date] for you. I can keep it until Friday, then it goes back on the calendar.”

> **Day 12:** “Hi [Name], I’ll close out your quote on Friday. If your plans change or you need a hand with part of it, reply and I’ll see what I can do.”

For business customers, a short monthly “I have trucks going your way on [day]” message keeps you in mind.

5. Ask for the review and the referral

Ask once everything is in and checked over, and text a direct link to your Google review page.

> “Thanks again, [Name]. If you’re happy with the move, would you leave a quick Google review? I’ll text you the link. And if a friend or coworker is moving, I’d be glad to help.”

Apartment managers, realtors and storage facilities meet people who are moving every week. Leave them cards and a short note.

Three rules that keep you out of trouble

- Get FMCSA authority and a USDOT number before you cross a state line, and read your truck and trailer weight ratings.
- Carry cargo coverage. General liability usually excludes the belongings and freight in your care.
- Know your cost per mile, empty miles included, and put detention, layover and extra-stop fees in writing.

General education, not legal, tax or insurance advice. Rules and prices vary by state, so check yours.
The full start-up guide for haulers and movers: followthroughguides.com/hauling-transportation · Questions: info@followthroughguides.com